

Using SMART Goals to Achieve Financial Freedom

SMART goals help you move from broad intentions to specific actions you can follow. These goals help give clear, actionable steps to building your financial future. Here is how to use each part of the SMART framework for your financial journey.

S

SPECIFIC: Be clear and direct about your financial target.

Avoid general goals like “save more money.” Instead, define exactly what you’re saving for and how much.

Example: “I will save \$500 per month for one year to build a \$6,000 emergency fund.”



M

MEASUREABLE: Track your progress with real numbers.

Having a measurable goal helps you stay accountable and celebrate milestones along the way.

Example: “I will reduce my credit card balance by \$200 each month until it’s paid off.”



A

ATTAINABLE: Set realistic financial goals.

Avoid setting goals that are too ambitious right away, they can lead to burnout or frustration. Instead, break larger goals into smaller, manageable steps that fit your current income and resources.

Example: “Instead of investing \$10,000 this year, I’ll start by contributing \$200 per



R

RELEVANT: Make sure your goal supports your long-term.

Choose goals that align with your priorities, whether it is saving for a home, paying down debt, or achieving early retirement.

Example: “I’ll pay off my car loan early to free up cash for investing.”



T

TIME-CONSTRAINED: Give every goal a clear deadline.

Deadlines provided motivation and prevent putting off tasks.

Example: “I will reach \$10,000 in my emergency fund by June 30, 2026.”



References:

<https://www.istockphoto.com/illustrations/green-dollar-sign>

<https://www.atlassian.com/blog/productivity/how-to-write-smart-goals>